

YRBS 2007 Final Individual Project Report

Topic: Physical Activity, Computer Use, Sleep, and BMI Percentile

Name: [Fill in your full name] Student ID: [Fill in your student ID]

1. Research Question

Among U.S. high school students in the YRBS 2007 dataset, is BMI percentile associated with physical activity days after adjusting for computer use, sleep, sex, and age?

2. Variables

Role	Dataset variable	Project variable	Description
Outcome	BMIPCT	bmi_percentile	BMI percentile based on age and sex.
Main predictor	PhysicalActivity5OrMore Days	physical_activity_days	Number of days physically active for at least 60 minutes in the past 7 days.
Control	ComputerUse	computer_use_hours	Approximate hours of non-school computer/video game use on an average school day.
Control	Sleep	sleep_hours	Approximate hours of sleep on an average school night.
Control	WhatIsYourSex	female	Female indicator: male = 0, female = 1.
Control	HowOldAreYou	age_years_approx	Approximate age in years.

3. Data Preparation

The original dataset contained 14,041 rows and 103 columns. I selected the variables needed for the research question, renamed them, and recoded ordinal survey answers into approximate numeric values. After removing rows with missing values in the selected variables, the final analysis sample contained 11,287 students.

4. Statistical Method

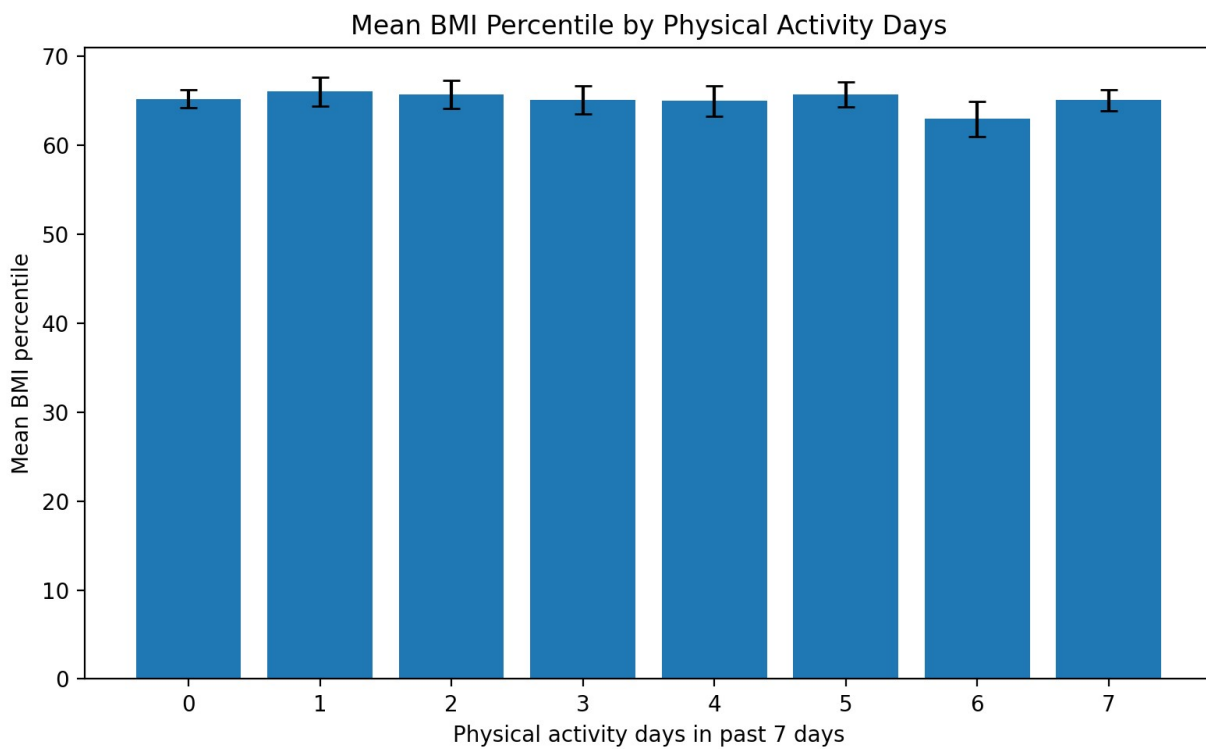
The approved method used in this project is multiple linear regression. This method is suitable because the outcome variable, BMI percentile, is numeric and the model can include several predictors at the same time.

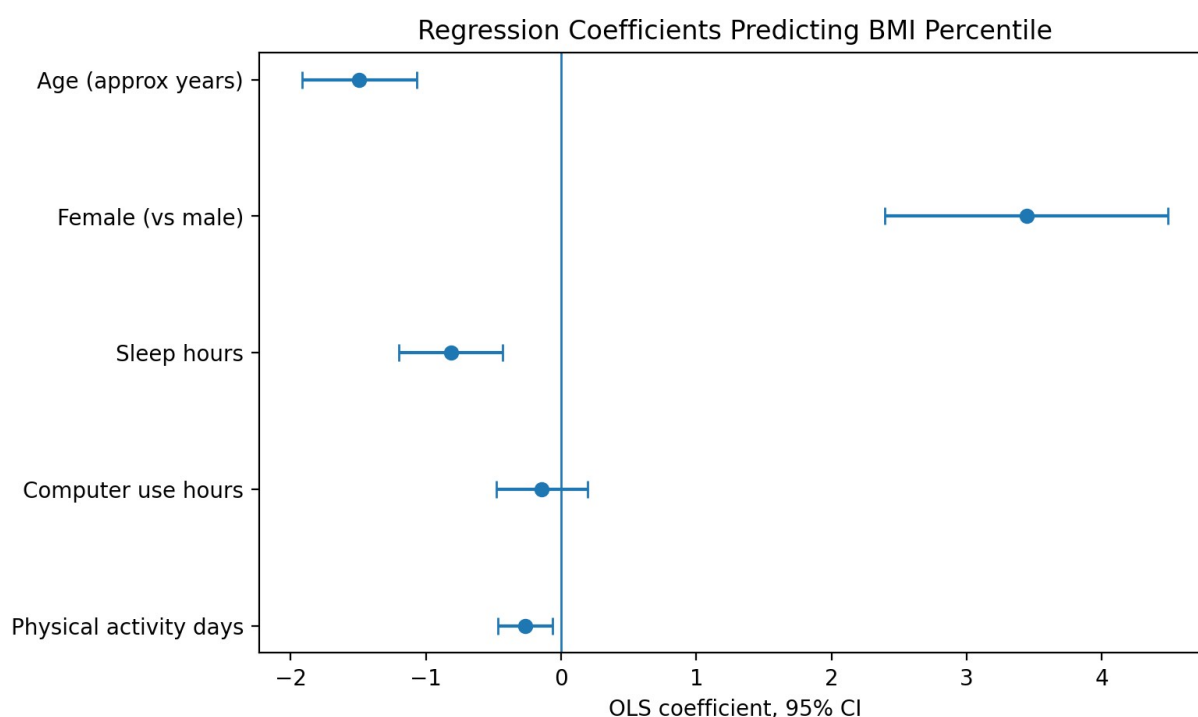
Model: $\text{BMI percentile} = b_0 + b_1(\text{activity days}) + b_2(\text{computer use hours}) + b_3(\text{sleep hours}) + b_4(\text{female}) + b_5(\text{age}) + \text{error}$

5. Results

The model used 11,287 complete observations. The R-squared value was 0.008, which means the predictors explained only a small amount of variation in BMI percentile.

Variable	Coefficient	Std. Error	t value	p value	CI Lower	CI Upper
Intercept	94.2177	3.9899	23.6138	0.0	86.3967	102.0386
Physical activity days	-0.267	0.1032	-2.5867	0.0097	-0.4693	-0.0647
Computer use hours	-0.1421	0.1715	-0.8288	0.4072	-0.4782	0.194
Sleep hours	-0.815	0.1965	-4.1472	0.0	-1.2001	-0.4298
Female (vs male)	3.4422	0.535	6.4334	0.0	2.3934	4.491
Age (approx years)	-1.4916	0.2154	-6.926	0.0	-1.9137	-1.0695





6. Interpretation and Conclusion

After adjusting for computer use, sleep, sex, and age, each additional physically active day was associated with -0.27 BMI percentile points. The p-value was 0.0097, so the association was statistically significant in the unweighted OLS model.

However, the practical effect was small. The low R-squared shows that these variables do not explain most differences in BMI percentile. The conclusion is that physical activity days have a weak negative association with BMI percentile, but BMI is influenced by many other factors not included in this model.

7. Limitations

This project uses observational survey data, so the results show association only and cannot prove causation. Some survey answer categories were recoded into approximate numeric values, which simplifies the original responses. Also, the main regression is unweighted OLS for course clarity; a weighted sensitivity result is provided in the output tables.

8. Submission Checklist

- Jupyter Notebook and code
- Cleaned data
- Figures and tables
- One-page infographic summary
- README.md with repository and YouTube links
- English presentation video script